

## Demonstrative pronouns

These **function as subjects or objects** in a sentence, replacing nouns. Don't confuse these with demonstrative determiners, which precede but do not replace the noun.

**this, that, these, those**

This pronoun is acting as the subject of the sentence.

**This** is my instrument.

## Interrogative pronouns

These are **used to ask questions** and represent an unknown subject or object.

**who, whom, what, which, whose**

This pronoun represents the subject, an unknown musician.

**Who** is playing?

## Indefinite pronouns

These **do not refer to any specific person or thing**, but take the place of nouns in a sentence.

**somebody, someone, something, anybody, anyone, anything, nobody, no one, nothing, all, another, both, each, many, most, other, some, few, none, such**

**I** haven't seen **anyone**.

This represents an unknown person, the object of the sentence.



- As a rule, a **pronoun cannot be modified** by an **adjective** or **adverb** in the way that a noun can be: For example, "the sad I" does not make sense. Some exceptions include "**what** else" and "**somebody** nice."
- Somebody* and *someone* **mean the same thing**, as do *anybody* and *anyone*, *everybody* and *everyone*, and *nobody* and *no one*.

## Talking about myself

Many people wrongly opt for the reflexive form *myself* because they are unsure whether to use *I* or *me*. Reflexive pronouns should only be used to refer back to a specific noun or pronoun that has already been mentioned in the sentence. This noun or pronoun is usually (but not always) the subject.

**I** imagined **myself** on the stage.

This reflexive pronoun correctly refers back to the subject, *I*.

Rita performed for Ben and **myself**.

This wrongly used reflexive pronoun has no noun to refer back to—there is no *I* in the sentence.



## Identifying when to use *I* or *me*

People often make mistakes when deciding whether to use the personal pronouns *I* or *me*. To figure out which to use, split the sentence into two short sentences. It should then become clear which one is right. Remember to put others first in a sentence.

**Me** and Ben enjoyed the concert. ❌

This doesn't make sense, so *me* is wrong.

**Me** enjoyed the concert. ❌

This makes sense, so *I* is the correct pronoun.

Ben enjoyed the concert. ✔️

**I** enjoyed the concert. ✔️

Always place others first.

Ben and **I** enjoyed the concert. ✔️

If the pronoun follows a preposition, the object personal pronoun *me* should be used.

This is a preposition, so the subject pronoun *I* is wrong.

It was a late night **for** Ben and **I**. ❌

It was a late night **for** Ben and **me**. ✔️

The object pronoun *me* now correctly follows the preposition *for*.